COURSE

AQA A-level Business (7132)

Management and leadership

3.2 Managers, leadership and decision making · 3.2.1 Understanding management, leadership and decision making

Revision for 3.2 Managers, leadership and decision making: each firm works it out on its own deals.

Class **AQA A-level Business (7132)** Topic **Management and leadership**

THE LESSON

Setup	3 min

Round 1 — Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min

Firm decisions	**Deals**	TASK 1 **Manage or lead?**	TASK 2 **Autocratic effects**

Round 2 — Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 3 min

Firm decisions	**Deals**	TASK 3 **Continuum in order**	TASK 4 **Error rate rise**	**B2B deal**

Round 3 — Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 3 min

Firm decisions	**Deals**	TASK 5 **New team, deadline**	TASK 6 **Leading the experts**	**B2B deal**

Final questions	3 min

Fits a 30-minute lesson setting; longer settings add more deals.

Each step

Firm decisions	Each role makes its decision on its own page.
Deals	Each pupil trades with a classmate in another firm.
Topic task	The firm answers together. Everyone presses Agree.
B2B deal	One firm sells a lot of cars to another firm.
Final questions	Each pupil answers six questions.

Firm decisions

CEO	**Staff**	Hire staff. Each costs a salary and gives one benefit.
	Sabotage FROM ROUND 2	Hit a rival firm's cash, at a cost. A Legal Counsel blocks it.
Sales & Marketing	**Marketing**	Book one advert campaign to lift the next sales.
Finance	**Capital & Loans**	Borrow cash. The firm pays it back with interest.
	Investments FROM ROUND 2	Buy property or funds. The value can rise or fall.
Operations	**Seasonal stock**	Order the season's cars in advance.

B2B deal · Rounds 2 and 3

One firm sells a lot of 3 cars to another firm (4 in Round 3). With an odd number of firms, two firms offer to sell and the lower price wins.

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same for every firm.

Task 1

ROUND 1

Your manager plans the staff rota, sets the budgets and checks the results each week.

Is this mainly management or leadership?

PICK ONE

- ○ Leadership: inspiring staff
- ○ Leadership: setting a vision
- ✔ **Management: planning and control**
- ○ Neither: it is just admin

Why: Planning, organising and controlling are management; leaders set direction.

Task 2

ROUND 1

A manager decides everything alone and gives orders.

Which two effects are most likely over time?

PICK TWO

- ○ Decisions take longer
- ✔ **Fast decisions in a crisis**
- ✔ **Skilled staff feel undervalued**
- ○ Staff feel more involved
- ○ Staff gain more responsibility

Why: Deciding alone is quick, but skilled staff want a say.

Task 3

ROUND 2

Four points on the Tannenbaum-Schmidt continuum.

Order them, boss-centred first?

PUT THESE IN ORDER, FIRST TO LAST · RIGHT ORDER

1. **Tells: decides and announces**
2. **Sells: decides, then persuades**
3. **Consults: asks, then decides**
4. **Delegates: the team decides**

Why: Along the continuum the manager uses less authority and staff gain freedom.

Task 4

ROUND 2

A new laissez-faire manager took over.

Rise in the error rate, as a %?

WORK OUT THE NUMBER, THEN PICK IT · EXAMPLE FIGURES

Deals a month	**200 deals**
Pricing errors before	**16 errors**
Pricing errors now	**24 errors**

METHOD

Rise % = (errors now − errors before) ÷ errors before × 100

(24 − 16) ÷ 16 × 100 = 50%

Why: Little direction suits skilled staff; here errors rose by 50%.

Task 5

ROUND 3

A new, untrained team must deliver a big fleet order by Friday.

Which approach fits, and why?

PICK A OR B AND GIVE A REASON

- ✔ **Clear instructions from the manager**
- ○ Let the team decide how

Why: Untrained staff and little time need clear direction.

Task 6

ROUND 3

Your senior technicians know the job better than you, and they want to plan the new workshop.

Using Tannenbaum-Schmidt, how should you lead them?

PICK ONE

- ○ Consults: asks, then decides
- ✔ **Delegates: the team decides**
- ○ Sells: decides, then persuades
- ○ Tells: decides and announces

Why: Skilled, keen staff can be given the most freedom on the continuum.

Final questions

6
questions for each pupil

109
Level 3 Business questions

2
of them on management and leadership

The game draws 6 of the 109 Level 3 questions; these 2 are about management and leadership.

1 A dealer says managers welcome challenge, but staff say every failed decision is punished. Which cultural effect is most likely?

Staff stop raising risks or new ideas.

2 A safety incident at a branch needs immediate coordinated action. Why might a usually participative leader become more directive for now?

Urgent risk needs fast, clear decisions.